EVENTFLOW
SCHEMATICS

User Tutorial

A complete guide to designing event technical schematics with EventFlow

What's inside

- Quickstart — your first schematic in 5 steps
- Complete UI walkthrough (panels, toolbar, status bar)
- Projects, schematics, pages, snapshots
- Building, connecting, tracing signal flow
- Equipment Editor and Custom Equipment Creator
- Departments, protocols, and colour coding
- Exporting PDF, Cable Schedule, BoM
- Full keyboard shortcut reference

Version 0.3.0

eventflow.app

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1. Welcome to EventFlow Schematics

EventFlow Schematics is a professional desktop application for designing event technical schematics — signal-flow diagrams, block diagrams, and system-layout drawings used by technical directors, system engineers, and production teams for live events, concerts, broadcasts, and installations.

It runs natively on Windows, macOS, and Linux via Tauri and React, giving you a fast, offline-capable tool with no subscription or cloud dependency. All your project data stays on your machine.

Who this tutorial is for

This guide is written for anyone who designs, reviews, or hands over technical drawings for events, including:

- Audio system engineers building FOH, monitor, and broadcast splits.
- Lighting designers and programmers planning fixture layouts and DMX universes.
- Video and broadcast engineers wiring switchers, scalers, and LED walls.
- Technical directors producing the master signal-flow document for a tour or installation.
- Production managers and crew chiefs who need clear cable schedules and bills of materials.

How to use this document

You can read the tutorial cover-to-cover, or jump to any section using the table of contents on the next page. Every chapter is self-contained and includes step-by-step walkthroughs, reference tables, and tips. The full keyboard-shortcut reference is in chapter 11.

> **Print-friendly:** This PDF is laid out for both screen reading and printing on A4. Use the "Background: White" PDF export option in the app for similarly print-friendly schematic exports.

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2. Quickstart — Your First Schematic

Follow these five steps to go from an empty canvas to a saved schematic with two connected pieces of equipment. The whole process takes about three minutes.

1. **Name your project**
   On first launch, EventFlow creates a project called "Untitled Project" automatically. Use File > Rename Project to give it a meaningful name such as "Stadium Show 2026" or "Theatre Hall Refit". The project name appears in the status bar and in every PDF export.

2. **Open the Symbol Library**
   The Symbol Library is the left-hand panel. It is organised by department — click the Sound, Lighting, Video, etc. tabs at the top to switch. Inside each department, equipment is grouped into collapsible categories (Consoles, Speakers, Cameras, etc.).

3. **Drag a console onto the canvas**
   In the Sound department, expand "Consoles", find "Yamaha CL5", and drag the card onto the white canvas in the centre. Release to drop. The node appears with input ports on its left edge and outputs on the right.

4. **Add a speaker and connect it**
   Drag a "Line Array Cabinet" from Sound > Speakers onto the canvas to the right of the console. Hover the console — the small coloured dots that appear are port handles. Click and drag from one of the right-side handles to a left-side handle on the speaker. Release. A coloured cable appears.

5. **Save your work**
   Press Ctrl+S. The amber "unsaved" dot in the status bar disappears. You now have a saved project with one schematic, one page, and one connection — the foundation of every signal-flow drawing.

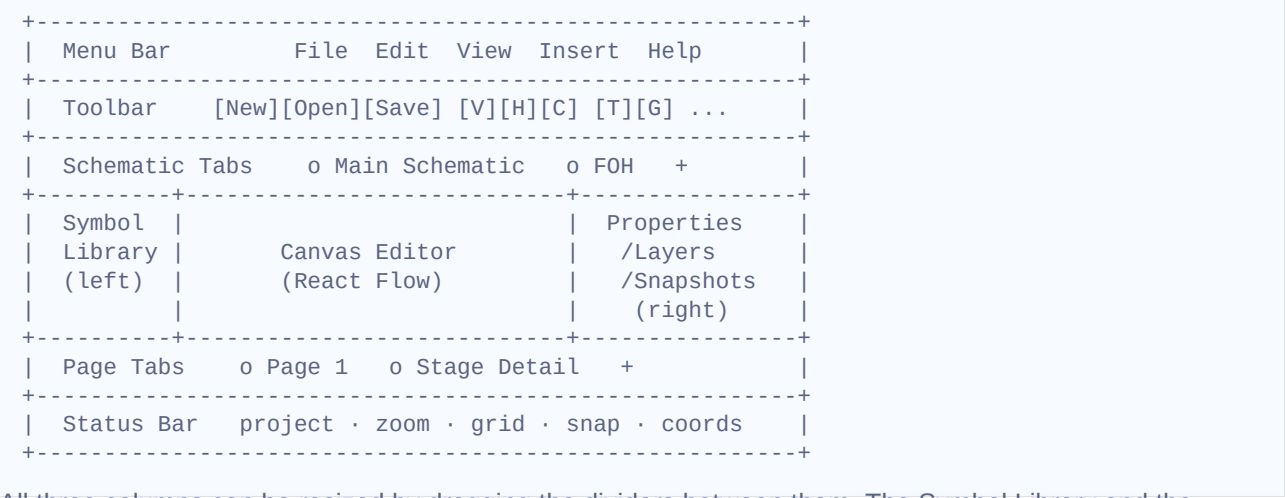
> **Tip:** EventFlow auto-saves every 60 seconds while changes are pending, but Ctrl+S immediately commits your work. Use Ctrl+Shift+S to also export a portable .evs file you can email to a colleague.

Key concepts

Concept	Definition
Project	The top-level container — holds your event name, client, venue, and all schematics.
Schematic	A named high-level view (e.g. "FOH Audio", "Video Distribution"). One project can have many schematics.
Page	A subdivision of a schematic — useful for overview vs. detail views, or zone breakdowns.
Symbol	A graphical representation of one piece of equipment, with ports, properties, and a department.
Connection	A cable between two equipment ports, carrying a protocol (Dante, SDI, DMX, etc.).
Layer	Visibility/lock group — one per department — so you can focus on one signal type at a time.
Snapshot	A named checkpoint of the canvas. Lets you experiment safely and roll back.

3. Interface Overview

EventFlow follows a familiar three-column desktop layout: tools on the left, canvas in the middle, properties on the right. The diagram below shows where to find every panel.



All three columns can be resized by dragging the dividers between them. The Symbol Library and the right-hand panel can be hidden from the View menu when you need maximum canvas space.

Menu Bar

Menu	Contains
File	New, Open, Save, Recent Projects, Save to File (.evs), Open from File (.evs), Rename, Export PDF, Export Cable Schedule (CSV), Export Bill of Materials (CSV), Print.
Edit	Undo / Redo, Cut / Copy / Paste / Duplicate, Select All, Equipment Editor, Add Custom Equipment.
View	Zoom In / Out / Fit, Toggle Grid, Toggle Snap, Toggle Minimap.
Insert	Equipment from Library, Custom Equipment, Text annotation, Image from File, Shape.
Schematic	New Page, New Schematic, Cable Schedule (CSV), Signal Trace.
Help	Open the in-app Help dialog and the About box.

Toolbar

Quick-access buttons for the most common actions. The currently active drawing tool is highlighted in blue.

Button	Action	Shortcut
New	Create a new project.	Ctrl+N
Open	Open Project Manager.	Ctrl+O
Save	Save project (glows blue when dirty).	Ctrl+S
Undo	Undo last action.	Ctrl+Z
Redo	Redo last undone action.	Ctrl+Y

Button	Action	Shortcut
Select (V)	Activate the select / inspect tool.	V
Pan (H)	Activate the pan tool.	H
Connect (C)	Activate the cable-draw tool.	C
Text (T)	Place a text annotation.	T
Group	Group selected nodes.	G
Custom Equipment	Open the Custom Equipment Creator.	Ctrl+Shift+N
Equipment Editor	Edit any existing symbol.	Ctrl+Shift+E
Export PDF	Open the PDF export dialog.	Ctrl+Shift+P

Symbol Library (left panel)

Browse and search every available equipment symbol, organised by department and category.

- Department tabs — switch between Sound, Lighting, Video, SFX, Rigging, Automation, Power, Networking, and Show Control.
- Search box — type two or more characters to search across ALL departments by name, model, category, or tag. Matches highlight as you type.
- Category sections — collapsible groups (Consoles, Speakers, Amps, Cameras, etc.) that keep dense departments tidy.
- Drag to canvas — click any card and drag it onto the canvas to place it. The node centres on your drop point.

Properties Panel (right panel — top tab)

Context-sensitive panel showing the details of whatever is currently selected on the canvas.

Selection	What is shown
Nothing selected	Hint text: "Click a node or connection to inspect it."
Equipment node	Department badge; editable name, manufacturer, model; ports list with direction arrows and protocol colours; key-value properties; editable position X / Y.
Annotation node	Text editor, font size, colour picker.
Group node	Editable group label.
Cable (edge)	Protocol colour; editable label, cable type, length in metres.

Layers Panel (right panel — second tab)

Toggle visibility and lock status of each department layer. Locking a layer prevents accidental moves or edits.

- Eye icon — show or hide the layer.
- Lock icon — lock or unlock the layer (turns amber when locked).
- Coloured dot — the department's accent colour for quick visual scanning.

Status Bar (bottom)

Indicator	Meaning
Project name + amber dot	Active project; the dot indicates unsaved changes.
Zoom %	Current canvas zoom level (range 10% – 400%).
Grid button	Click to toggle the dot/line grid overlay.
Snap button	Click to toggle snap-to-grid.
Cursor coords	Real-time X/Y position of the mouse on the canvas.
Selection badge	Number of nodes/edges currently selected.
Department dot + name	Active department filter for the Symbol Library.

4. Projects, Schematics, Pages, and Snapshots

Understanding the four-level hierarchy is the key to keeping large designs organised. Each level exists for a reason.

```
Project  ("Stadium Show 2026")
  +-- Schematic  ("FOH Audio")
  |     +-- Page  ("Overview")
  |     +-- Page  ("Stage Detail")
  |     +-- Layers  [Sound | Lighting | Video | ...]
  +-- Schematic  ("Video Distribution")
        +-- Page  ("Page 1")
```

Creating and managing projects

Action	How
New project	Press Ctrl+N or File > New Project. Type a name in the prompt.
Open a saved project	Press Ctrl+O or File > Open Project. Pick from the project manager list.
Save to app storage	Press Ctrl+S — the amber dot disappears. Auto-save runs every 60 s while pending.
Save to disk (.evs)	Press Ctrl+Shift+S — downloads a portable .evs file containing all canvas data, custom equipment, and snapshots.
Open from disk (.evs)	File > Open from File (.evs). Restores the full canvas and snapshot history.
Rename project	File > Rename Project — type the new name in the prompt.
Delete project	Open Project Manager (Ctrl+O), hover the project, click Delete, then confirm.

Schematics (top tab bar)

Schematics appear as coloured tabs along the top of the canvas. Each tab has a department-coloured indicator dot.

Action	How
Switch schematic	Click its tab.
Add schematic	Click the + button at the end of the tab bar. Enter a name, choose a department, click Add.
Rename schematic	Double-click the tab. Type the new name and press Enter (or click away).
Delete schematic	Hover the tab to reveal the red x. Click once (it turns red — a 3-second confirm window). Click again to confirm. The last schematic cannot be deleted.

Pages (bottom tab bar)

Pages let you split a single schematic into multiple sheets — for example "Overview", "Stage Left Detail", "Server Rack". Each page tab gets a unique colour from an 8-colour palette automatically.

Action	How
Switch page	Click its tab.
Add page	Click the + button. The page is auto-named "Page N" and gets a fresh colour.
Delete page	Hover the tab to reveal the x button. Click it. The last page cannot be deleted.
Rename page	Use Schematic > New Page with a custom name (inline rename is coming).

Named snapshots

Snapshots capture the full canvas state at a point in time. Use them as checkpoints before major changes — you can always restore in a single click.

Action	How
Save a snapshot	Open the Snapshots tab in the right panel. Type a name and press Enter (or click Save). Node and edge counts are shown on the card.
Restore a snapshot	Click the restore icon. An amber warning appears — click again within 3 seconds to confirm. The canvas state is replaced.
Delete a snapshot	Hover the card to reveal the trash icon.

> **Note:** Snapshots are embedded in .evs files — they travel with the project when you share it. They cost very little disk space because EventFlow deduplicates equipment definitions.

5. Working on the Canvas

The canvas is where the work happens. This chapter covers placement, selection, drawing connections, navigation, and the routing tools that keep dense schematics readable.

Placing equipment

1. **Find your symbol**
   Open the Symbol Library, choose the department tab, browse categories — or just type into the search box (it searches across ALL departments).
2. **Drag and drop**
   Click and hold a symbol card; drag it onto the canvas; release. The node is placed and centred on the drop point.
3. **Snap to grid (optional)**
   If Snap is enabled (Ctrl+Shift+G or the Snap button), dropped nodes align to the nearest 20-pixel grid intersection automatically.

Selecting and moving

Action	How
Select a node or cable	Click on it with the Select tool (V).
Multi-select	Hold Shift and click, or drag a selection rectangle on empty canvas.
Move a node	Drag it to a new position.
Delete selected items	Press Backspace or Delete.
Deselect all	Click on empty canvas space.

Drawing connections

Every equipment node has port handles — small coloured dots on its edges. Inputs are on the left, outputs on the right. Port colours indicate the signal protocol.

1. **Hover a node**
   Port handles appear on the edges.
2. **Drag from a handle**
   Click and drag from any port handle to start drawing a cable.
3. **Connect to destination**
   Release on a handle of the target node. A coloured edge appears representing the connection.

> **Loose connection mode:** EventFlow lets you connect any port to any other port regardless of direction or protocol. Cross-protocol connections show a red conflict glow but are not blocked, so you stay flexible when wiring complex real-world systems.

Navigating the canvas

Action	How

Action	How
Pan	Middle-mouse drag, right-mouse drag, or activate the Pan tool (H) and left-drag.
Zoom in / out	Mouse wheel.
Zoom range	10% – 400%.
Fit all content	Click the Fit button in the React Flow controls (bottom-left of canvas) or press Ctrl+0.

Grid and snap

Control	Where
Toggle grid display	Status Bar > Grid button, or Ctrl+G.
Toggle snap to grid	Status Bar > Snap button, or Ctrl+Shift+G.
Grid size	20 px (fine) with a heavier line every 100 px (coarse).

Undo and redo

EventFlow tracks 50 steps of canvas history (node positions and connections). Use Ctrl+Z and Ctrl+Y liberally — there is no risk.

Connection routing and styles

Select any cable and use the Properties panel to fine-tune its appearance and routing.

Property	Options
Line Style	Auto (uses the protocol visual), Solid, Dashed, Dotted.
Routing	Bezier (smooth curve) or Orthogonal (right-angle steps).
Bends / Angles	Double-click a cable to drop a bend point exactly where you click, then drag the dot to route it. Add up to 10 bends to route around devices and keep links from overlapping. Right-click or double-click a dot to remove it.
Fine-tune each bend	Properties > Bends / Angles lists every angle with X and Y steppers (+/-1, Shift +/-10, Ctrl +/-50), plus Add angle and Clear buttons.
90 degree snapping	While you drag a bend it snaps to line up with its neighbours for clean right angles. Toggle it in Canvas Settings > 90 Link Snap; hold Alt to bypass it temporarily.

1. **Add an angle**
   Double-click anywhere on a cable. A bend point appears exactly there and the link now routes through it.
2. **Route it**
   Drag the bend dot to move that corner. With 90 degree snapping on, it locks to horizontal/vertical alignment with the neighbouring points.
3. **Repeat as needed**
   Add up to ten bends per cable to steer it cleanly around devices and other links.
4. **Remove a bend**
   Right-click (or double-click) the dot, or use the trash icon on its row in Properties > Bends / Angles.

Working with images

You can bring reference images, plans, logos, and product photos into a schematic.

Image use	How
Place an image	Three ways: Toolbar > Insert Image, the Insert menu > Image from File, or paste from the clipboard with Ctrl+V. It drops on the canvas as a movable, resizable object and is included in PDF exports.
Canvas background	Canvas Settings > Background Image: upload a plan or reference image behind the schematic, with opacity and Contain / Cover controls. Shown on screen only; not part of the PDF export.
Device photo	Select a device > Properties > Production > Photo: paste a URL or Upload from file. The photo then appears on the device on the canvas.

Resizing devices

Every device can be resized to match its real-world footprint or to make dense racks readable.

1. **Select the device**
   Click it once. Resize handles appear on its corners and edges.
2. **Drag a handle**
   Drag any corner or edge handle to resize. Hold Shift while dragging a corner to keep the aspect ratio.
3. **Or type exact values**
   Open Properties > Position & Size and enter precise Width and Height in pixels.

Locking devices

Lock a device to protect it from accidental moves or deletion — useful once a rack is finalised.

Action	How
Lock / unlock	Click the padlock icon on a selected device, or use the Lock toggle in the Properties panel.
Locked behaviour	A locked device cannot be dragged or deleted until you unlock it. Its connections still update normally.

Custom device colours

Override the department accent on any individual device — handy for flagging spares, hires, or problem gear.

1. **Open Appearance**
   Select a device and open Properties > Appearance.
2. **Pick a colour**
   Choose a preset swatch or a fully custom colour. The device header, border, and its minimap dot all follow the chosen colour.
3. **Reset**
   Clear the override to return the device to its department colour.

Editing port labels

Rename any input or output directly so the schematic speaks your venue's language.

Field	Meaning
Port name	Edit inline in Properties > Ports.
Direction	Shown clearly as IN, OUT, or I-O next to each port.

Zone separators

A Zone is a dashed, no-fill rectangle used to mark areas — Front of House, Stage Left, Dimmer World — without obscuring the equipment inside it.

1. **Add a zone**
   Toolbar > Shapes > Zone, then drag it over the area you want to mark.
2. **Label it**
   Double-click the zone to add a label.
3. **It stays back**
   Zones render behind devices so they never block selection or connection.

6. Equipment, Symbols, and Customisation

Symbols are the building blocks of every schematic. EventFlow ships with hundreds of built-in symbols — but the real power comes from being able to edit them and create your own.

What is a symbol?

A symbol represents a physical piece of equipment — a console, amplifier, camera, dimmer rack, etc. Each symbol has:

- A graphical SVG preview shown in the library and on the canvas.
- Port definitions — every input and output the device exposes, with direction and protocol.
- Properties — a key-value spec sheet (model, power draw, weight, dimensions).
- Tags — search keywords that surface the symbol when you type in the library.

Built-in library highlights (Sound is fully populated)

Category	Examples
Consoles	Yamaha CL5, DM7, RIVAGE PM5/PM10, QL5; DiGiCo SD7, Quantum 338/225; Analog Console.
Speakers	Line Array Cabinet, Subwoofer, Monitor Wedge, Delay Speaker, In-Ear Monitor.
Microphones	Dynamic, Condenser, Lavalier, Boundary, Wireless Handheld / Bodypack.
Amplifiers	Power Amplifier, Crown DCi, Lab.gruppen PLM.
Processing	Audio DSP, Crossover, Graphic EQ, Compressor / Gate, Delay Unit.
Networking	Dante Switch, Stage Box, MADI Converter, Audio Interface, Patch Bay.
Playback	CD Player, Media Server, Playback System.

Lighting, Video, SFX, Rigging, Automation, Power, Networking, and Show Control departments ship with placeholder symbols and will be expanded in upcoming releases.

Searching for equipment

Click the search box at the top of the Symbol Library and start typing. Results appear across ALL departments as soon as you type two or more characters. Matches are highlighted and tagged with their category badge.

Equipment Editor — modify any symbol

Open with Ctrl+Shift+E or via Edit > Equipment Editor. Every symbol — including built-ins — can be edited. Changes are stored locally as overrides; the original definition is never lost.

1. **Pick a symbol**
   Use the department sidebar and category tree to find the symbol.
2. **Edit on the right**
   Four tabs: General (name, category, SVG, dimensions); Ports (add / remove / edit); Properties (spec key-value pairs); Tags (search keywords).
3. **Save**
   Click Save. Your version appears immediately in the library.

4. **Reset (anytime)**
   Each edited symbol shows a Reset button that restores it to factory defaults.

> **Tip:** Use the Equipment Editor when your specific console has different I/O than the generic Yamaha CL5 entry — for example custom Dante card configurations.

Custom Equipment Creator — build a symbol from scratch

Open with Ctrl+Shift+N or Insert > Custom Equipment. Use this for proprietary, one-off, or specialised gear that is not in the built-in library.

1. **Identity**
   Name, department (sets accent colour and layer), category (groups it under the right heading in the library).
2. **SVG (optional)**
   Paste an SVG path string for a custom icon preview. Leave blank to use the default generic device rectangle. ViewBox is 48 x 40.
3. **Ports**
   Define every input and output: name, direction (In / Out), and protocol (Dante, SDI, DMX, etc.).
4. **Properties & tags**
   Spec sheet entries (model, power draw, weight) and search keywords.
5. **Save to library**
   Custom symbols appear under their department tab, ready to drag onto any canvas.

> **Tip:** Custom symbols are stored in your local project data and are also embedded in any .evs file you export — share the file and your colleague gets your custom gear automatically.

7. Departments and Protocols

Every symbol and every connection in EventFlow belongs to a department. Departments determine the accent colour used throughout the UI — node headers, edge strokes, layer indicators, schematic tabs, library tabs.

The nine departments

Sound `#3B82F6`
Audio mixing consoles, speakers, microphones, amplifiers, audio networking (Dante, MADI, AES50).

Lighting `#F59E0B`
Lighting desks, dimmer racks, moving lights, LED fixtures, control networking (DMX-512, sACN, ArtNet).

Video `#8B5CF6`
Cameras, video switchers, scalers, LED walls, video display distribution (SDI, HDMI, NDI, DVI).

SFX `#EF4444`
Pyrotechnics control, CO2, confetti, atmospheric effects firing systems and timers.

Rigging `#10B981`
Hoists, truss structures, rigging points, chain motors, load monitoring.

Automation `#06B6D4`
Stage automation, turntables, lifts, flying systems, position feedback.

Power `#F97316`
Generators, distribution boards, PDUs, UPS systems, cable power routing.

Networking `#6366F1`
Managed switches, routers, firewalls, VLANs — the IT infrastructure underpinning show data networks.

Show Control `#EC4899`
Timecode, cue systems, MIDI show control, OSC, show management software (QLab, Medialon, Alcorn McBride).

Protocol colour coding

Connection cables are colour-coded by signal protocol. The colour is also used on the matching port handles, making correct connections a visual exercise. Hover a connection at any time to see its protocol name.

Dante · AES50 · MADI · AES3 · Analog Audio · SDI · NDI · HDMI · DMX-512 · sACN · Ethernet · MIDI · OSC · GPIO · Timecode

Use the Properties panel to override the protocol on any individual cable, or to switch a cable to "custom" — which suppresses protocol-mismatch warnings entirely (useful for analog adapters and patch cables).

8. Advanced Features

Signal Path Tracer

The signal tracer highlights the full signal chain connected to any piece of equipment — both upstream and downstream — making it easy to follow complex routing in dense schematics.

1. **Hover over a node**
   Hover any equipment node to reveal its action buttons.
2. **Click the Waypoints icon**
   The Waypoints button is the first action button on hover. Click to start the trace.
3. **Read the result**
   Connected nodes and cables stay full-opacity. Everything else fades to 20%. A green Tracing badge appears in the toolbar.
4. **Clear the trace**
   Click x next to the Tracing badge, press Escape, or click the Waypoints button again on the active node.

> **Tip:** The tracer follows all connections bidirectionally. Use it before a show to verify every path from input to output is complete and no devices are stranded.

Protocol conflict detection

EventFlow validates connections continuously and warns when a cable's protocol does not match the port protocol of either device.

When you draw a mismatched connection, a confirmation pop-up appears: "You are trying to link a [X] port to a [Y] port. Continue anyway?" Choose Yes to keep the connection or No to cancel it. Tick "Don't show me again" to suppress the pop-up for the rest of your session.

Visual	Meaning
Confirmation pop-up	Appears the moment you complete a mismatched connection — Yes keeps it, No cancels it.
Red glow on a cable	Protocol mismatch — the edge protocol differs from the source or target port.
Red "!" badge on cable	Hover or select the cable to see which port mismatches.
No indicator	Connection is valid, or uses the "custom" protocol which skips validation.

> **Note:** Conflicts are warnings only — connections are NEVER blocked. Use them to catch wiring errors before the gear arrives at the venue.

Alignment & distribution tools

When two or more nodes are selected, a contextual alignment bar appears directly below the main toolbar. The bar auto-hides when you deselect, keeping the UI clean.

Button	Action	Min nodes
Align Left	Snap left edges to the leftmost node.	2
Align Center (H)	Align horizontal centres.	2

Button	Action	Min nodes
Align Right	Snap right edges to the rightmost node.	2
Align Top	Snap top edges to the topmost node.	2
Align Center (V)	Align vertical centres.	2
Align Bottom	Snap bottom edges to the bottommost node.	2
Distribute H	Space nodes evenly across the horizontal span.	3
Distribute V	Space nodes evenly across the vertical span.	3
Group	Wrap selected nodes in a labelled bounding box.	2

Smart groups

Groups are resizable, labelled bounding boxes that visually organise related equipment. They render behind other nodes so they never block selection.

Action	How
Create a group	Select 2+ nodes, then click Group in the alignment bar (or press G).
Move a group	Drag the group frame — all member nodes move with it automatically.
Resize a group	Click to select; drag the handles on its edges and corners.
Edit group label	Select the group; change the label in the Properties panel.
Delete a group	Select and press Backspace/Delete. Member nodes are NOT deleted.

Text annotations

Place free-form text labels anywhere on the canvas — for notes, zone labels, rack identifiers, or design instructions.

1. **Activate the Text tool**
   Press T or click the T button in the toolbar.
2. **Click the canvas**
   A text field appears at the click position. Type your annotation.
3. **Confirm**
   Press Enter or click elsewhere to place. Use Shift+Enter for a line break.
4. **Edit later**
   Double-click any annotation node to re-enter edit mode.

> **Tip:** Annotation font size and colour can be adjusted in the Properties panel when an annotation is selected.

Minimap

A small overview map can be toggled from View > Toggle Minimap. It uses department colours to distinguish nodes at a glance, and you can click and drag inside it to pan the main canvas quickly — invaluable for very large schematics.

9. Production Tooling (v0.3.0)

Version 0.3.0 introduces a suite of show-production helpers that turn a schematic into actionable rigging, power, networking and logistics paperwork. Every tool reads from the equipment Production properties you set in the Properties panel.

Production properties on equipment

Select any equipment node and open the Production section in the Properties panel. These fields drive every production tool described in this chapter.

Field	Use
Photo URL	Manufacturer image. Renders a thumbnail in the panel and on PDF exports.
Wattage (W)	Real-world power draw. Drives the Status Bar power load.
Phase (L1/L2/L3)	Mains phase the device is plugged into.
DMX Universe / Address / Footprint	Lighting fixture DMX patch.
IP address	Network address (Dante, sACN, Art-Net, NDI…).
Weight (kg)	For truck-pack totals.
W / H / D (mm)	Outer dimensions. Drives volume calculation.
Road Case ID	Groups items into the same case for the truck pack.
Day rate	Quoting / costing reference.

Live power load (Status Bar)

The status bar shows total amps and a per-phase breakdown (L1 / L2 / L3) computed at 230 V. The pill turns amber when phases differ by more than 20%, and red when any phase exceeds 80% of a 32 A circuit. Hover for a full breakdown.

Tools menu

Tool	Effect
Auto-allocate DMX Addresses	Packs fixtures contiguously per universe (1–64), respecting any addresses already pinned. Reports clashes.
Auto-allocate IP Addresses	Assigns sequential IPs (default 10.0.0.10+) to networked devices: Art-Net, sACN, Dante, AES67, AVB, Milan, NDI, ST-2110, OSC, Ethernet.
Assign Cable IDs	Stamps idempotent IDs (CAB-001, CAB-002…) onto every edge. Cable IDs appear in the Properties panel and the Cable Schedule export.
Validate Schematic	Full check: unconnected ports, protocol mismatches, both-input/both-output edges, distance limits per protocol, DMX clashes, IP duplicates.

MVR import (File > Import MVR…)

Load a .mvr bundle (My Virtual Rig) exported from GDTF-aware tools such as Vectorworks, grandMA3, or MA

Lighting plot tools. EventFlow reads GeneralSceneDescription.xml, walks the layer / fixture tree, places each fixture on the canvas at its real-world XY (100 px per metre), and pre-fills DMX universe and address from the MVR Addresses block.

Truck Pack export (File > Export Truck Pack)

Groups equipment by Road Case ID, sums weight (kg) and volume (litres from W x H x D), and writes a CSV with subtotals per case plus a grand total. Items without a case ID land in a "Loose Gear" bucket. Perfect for the truckmaster.

CAD title block (PDF export)

The PDF export dialog now exposes Revision, Sheet n / N, Venue, Event Date, and Scale. Enable the CAD title block option to render an industry-standard corner block in the bottom-right of every page, alongside (or instead of) the lightweight header strip.

10. Exporting

EventFlow exports to four formats out of the box: PDF (for client deliverables and printing), CSV cable schedules (with Cable IDs), CSV bills of materials, and CSV truck-pack manifests grouped by road case.

Exporting as PDF

Open with Ctrl+Shift+P, File > Export PDF, or the Download button in the toolbar. The export dialog gives you full control over page size, quality, and title-block content.

Option	Choices	Default
Page Size	A4, A3, A2, Letter, Tabloid	A3
Orientation	Landscape, Portrait	Landscape
Quality	Screen 1x (72 dpi), Print 1.5x (108 dpi), High 2x (144 dpi), Ultra 3x (216 dpi), Max 4.2x (300 dpi)	1.5x (Print)
Background	Dark (app theme), White (print-friendly)	Dark
Header strip	On / Off	On
Footer strip	On / Off	On
CAD Title Block	On / Off — bottom-right corner block (NEW v0.3.0)	On
Connection schedule page	On / Off — appends a "what links to what" table (NEW v0.3.1)	On
Project Name	Text field	Active project name
Schematic Name	Text field	Active schematic name
Client	Text field	(blank)
Designer	Text field	(blank)
Venue	Text field (NEW)	(blank)
Event Date	Text field (NEW)	(blank)
Revision	Text field (NEW)	A
Sheet / Total	Numbers (NEW) — for multi-page sets	1 / 1
Scale	Text field (NEW)	NTS
Filename	Text field (no .pdf extension needed)	<ProjectName>_schematic

Tip: For client deliverables, choose A3 Landscape, Quality High 2x, Background White, enable the CAD Title Block, and fill in Client, Designer, Venue, Event Date, and Revision. The bottom-right corner gets an industry-standard CAD title block with grid cells.

Auto-fit & background: Exports automatically frame the entire schematic into a 16:9 area, so the current on-screen zoom and pan no longer affect the result. The whole page is filled with the chosen background colour, and White (print) now produces a genuinely white page. The Max 4.2x option renders at about 300 dpi for print-ready detail.

Connection schedule page: Leave the Connection schedule page option on and the PDF ends with a "what links to what" reference page: every connection listed with its source device and output port, destination device and input port, protocol, and cable ID / type / length. Large schematics flow onto extra pages automatically, so the exported document explains the whole signal flow on its own — no separate CSV needed.

Cable Schedule (CSV)

File > Export Cable Schedule (CSV) — generates a spreadsheet-ready CSV listing every connection in the current schematic.

Column	Contents
#	Row number.
Label	Cable label (or edge ID if blank).
From Device	Source equipment label.
From Port	Source port name.
To Device	Destination equipment label.
To Port	Destination port name.
Protocol	Protocol name (Dante, DMX-512, SDI...).
Cable Type	Cable type string.
Length (m)	Cable length in metres, if set.
Notes	Free-form notes.

Downloads as <ProjectName>_cable_schedule.csv. The cable team can open it in Excel, Numbers, or Google Sheets and use it as the master pull list.

Bill of Materials (CSV)

File > Export Bill of Materials (CSV) — lists every unique equipment type in the schematic, grouped and counted by department.

Column	Contents
Qty	Number of instances of this type.
Department	Department name.
Equipment Type	Symbol / model type identifier.
Sample Label	Label of one representative instance.
Notes	(blank — for manual completion).

Downloads as <ProjectName>_bom.csv.

PNG Export

File > Export PNG (Ctrl+E) — listed in the menu but not yet implemented. Coming in a future update.

11. Keyboard Shortcuts

Master these to drive EventFlow at full speed. Tool shortcuts (single-key V/H/C/T/G) are intentionally blocked while a text input or textarea is focused, so typing a label never accidentally switches your tool.

File and project

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl+N	New project.
Ctrl+O	Open project manager.
Ctrl+S	Save project to app storage.
Ctrl+Shift+S	Save to file (.evs) — portable export.
Ctrl+Shift+P	Export PDF (open dialog).
Ctrl+E	Export PNG (not yet implemented).
Ctrl+P	Print (not yet implemented).

Edit

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl+Z	Undo.
Ctrl+Y	Redo.
Ctrl+X	Cut selected nodes.
Ctrl+C	Copy selected nodes.
Ctrl+V	Paste copied nodes (offset +20 px).
Ctrl+D	Duplicate selected nodes in place.
Backspace / Delete	Delete selected nodes or connections.
Ctrl+A	Select all nodes.
Ctrl+Shift+E	Open Equipment Editor.
Ctrl+Shift+N	Open Custom Equipment Creator.

View

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl+G	Toggle grid overlay.
Ctrl+Shift+G	Toggle snap-to-grid.
Ctrl+=	Zoom in.
Ctrl+-	Zoom out.

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl+0	Zoom to fit.

Drawing tools

Shortcut	Action
V	Activate Select tool.
H	Activate Pan tool.
C	Activate Connect (cable draw) tool.
T	Activate Text annotation tool.
G	Activate Group tool.

Canvas navigation

Shortcut	Action
Mouse wheel	Zoom in / out.
Middle-mouse drag	Pan canvas.
Right-mouse drag	Pan canvas.
Shift + click	Add to / remove from selection.
Shift + drag	Draw selection rectangle.

Dialogs and tab bars

Shortcut	Action
F1	Open / close the in-app Help.
Escape	Close most dialogs; cancel rename; exit trace mode.
Enter	Confirm inline rename.
Shift+Enter	Insert line break in a text annotation.

12. Tips & Tricks

- **Two-click delete protection**
  Deleting a schematic tab requires two clicks — the first turns the x red for 3 seconds as a safety window, preventing accidental deletion of complex schematics.
- **Search across departments**
  The Symbol Library search box searches ALL departments at once, even when you are on a specific department tab. Use it to find equipment by model number or tag.
- **Local equipment overrides**
  Any change in the Equipment Editor is stored as a local override. Click Reset on a symbol to return it to factory defaults without losing your other edits.
- **White background for printing**
  When exporting PDF for printing, switch Background to White and increase Quality to High 2x or Ultra 3x for sharp printed output.
- **Dirty indicator = your cue**
  The amber dot next to the project name is your cue to press Ctrl+S. Auto-save also runs every 60 seconds while changes are pending.
- **Save to disk for portability**
  Ctrl+Shift+S exports a .evs file you can share or back up. A colleague can open it via File > Open from File on their machine — custom equipment travels with it.
- **Snapshot before experimenting**
  Before major layout changes, save a named snapshot. If the result is wrong, restore the snapshot in one click.
- **Trace before go-live**
  Use the signal tracer to verify every cable path is complete. Unconnected or misrouted devices are visually isolated.
- **Alignment bar is context-aware**
  The alignment toolbar only appears when 2+ nodes are selected — and auto-hides when you deselect.
- **Export the cable schedule**
  File > Export Cable Schedule creates a CSV your cable team can open in Excel.
- **Loose connections**
  EventFlow lets you connect any port to any other regardless of direction or protocol — this is intentional for flexibility.
- **Use layers for focused editing**
  Lock or hide layers for departments you are not currently editing.
- **Undo has 50 steps**
  If you make a series of mistakes, keep pressing Ctrl+Z — you have up to 50 steps to go back.
- **Minimap for large schematics**
  Enable the minimap from View > Toggle Minimap; click and drag inside it to pan the main canvas.
- **Page colours are automatic**
  Each page tab gets a unique colour from an 8-colour palette so you can tell pages apart at a glance.
- **Tool shortcuts and inputs**
  Single-key tool shortcuts (V, H, C, T, G) are intentionally blocked while a text input or textarea is focused — typing a label will never accidentally switch your tool.

13. Licensing & Activation

EventFlow Schematics is distributed as a 15-day free trial. During the trial every feature is unlocked. When the trial ends the app stops opening until a valid licence key is entered. Activating a key unlocks the application permanently on that computer — no internet connection is required.

How the trial works

State	What happens
First launch	A 15-day countdown starts automatically. A banner at the top shows the days remaining.
During the trial	Every feature is available. Click ACTIVATE on the demo banner to open the licence dialog at any time.
Trial expired (no licence)	A lock screen appears on launch with your Machine ID and a field to enter a licence key.
Licensed	The app opens straight to your work — no banner, no countdown, no expiry.

Activating your licence

1. **Find your Machine ID**
   Open the activation screen — the lock screen, or click ACTIVATE on the demo banner. Your unique Machine ID is shown there with a Copy button.
2. **Request a licence**
   Send your Machine ID together with your purchase request to dhiraj.kalra@gmail.com. Licence keys are issued per machine.
3. **Enter the key**
   Paste the licence key you receive into the activation field and click Activate. The app unlocks immediately.
4. **Done**
   The licence is stored securely on this computer. You will not be asked again on this machine.

> **Tip:** Because licences are tied to a machine, keep a note of your key. If you move to a new computer, contact us with the new Machine ID for a transfer.

Licensing FAQ

Question	Answer
Does activation need the internet?	No. Keys are verified entirely offline on your machine.
Will reinstalling reset the trial?	No. The trial start date is stored in protected, uninstall-resistant locations.
Can one key work on several PCs?	No. Each key is bound to a single computer's Machine ID.
My clock change says "tampered".	Moving the system clock backwards is detected as tampering. Set the correct date/time and relaunch, or contact support.

14. Troubleshooting & FAQ

Common issues

Issue	Resolution
I dragged a symbol but nothing appeared on the canvas.	Check that the canvas has focus (click it once first). If a layer is locked or hidden, dropped equipment for that department may not be visible — check the Layers panel.
My cable shows a red conflict glow.	The protocol on the cable does not match one of its endpoints. Select the cable, change its protocol in the Properties panel, or set it to "custom" to suppress the warning.
Single-key shortcuts (V, H, C...) do nothing.	They are blocked while any text input or textarea is focused. Click on empty canvas first, then press the shortcut.
I cannot delete the last schematic / page.	A project must always contain at least one schematic, and each schematic must contain at least one page. Add a replacement first, then delete the old one.
PDF export looks pixelated.	Increase the Quality setting (High 2x or Ultra 3x) and/or switch Background to White if printing.
I lost my custom equipment.	Custom equipment lives in your local app data. If you switched machines, open the .evs file from your old machine on the new one — custom symbols are embedded.
Demo version expired earlier than expected.	The demo is a 15-day trial measured from the FIRST launch on this machine. Reinstalling does NOT reset the clock. See chapter 13 (Licensing & Activation) to unlock the full version.

Where is my data stored?

Projects, custom equipment, and equipment overrides are stored in your operating system's standard application data directory:

- Windows: %APPDATA%\com.eventflow.schematics
- macOS: ~/Library/Application Support/com.eventflow.schematics
- Linux: ~/.config/com.eventflow.schematics

Use the .evs file format (Ctrl+Shift+S) for portable backup and sharing.

Getting more help

Press F1 inside the application at any time to open the in-app Help dialog, which mirrors this tutorial and is always up to date with the version you have installed. For licensing, custom symbol libraries, or feature requests, contact us at dhiraj.kalra@gmail.com.